



Weekly Insights | Oct 23, 2025

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Executive Summary

Corn – Flat Futures, Carry Firms as CIF Bids Climb

December corn climbed 2¢ at \$4.34/bu, trading in a narrow range as solid export inspections and Gulf basis gains offset harvest pressure. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 14.25¢ (71 percent of full carry), its firmest in over a month, as exporters chased near-term supply. CIF basis strengthened 5–7¢ on strong Gulf demand, while river markets improved where barge traffic normalized. Weekly inspections reached 1.69 MMT for the week ending Oct 30, more than double last year's volume.

Soybeans – Modest Rally on Trade Optimism, Basis Softens at Gulf

January 2026 soybeans rose 32¢ to \$11.24/bu, notching a one-year high on expectations that China might resume purchases after a Nov 10 tariff rollback. Gulf basis eased 3–5¢ on soft Chinese offtake, while Jan/Mar held near 11¢ (59 percent of full carry) as crushers remained active. Export inspections slipped to 0.96 MMT (–9 percent w/w), reflecting delays in recent bookings. Processor bids held steady at +20 to +30¢ across much of the Midwest.

Wheat – Futures Extend Gains on Plains Dryness, Spreads Steady

December SRW wheat gained 21¢ to \$5.53/bu (+4 percent), continuing its recovery on dry conditions in HRW regions and fund short-covering. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 13¢ (68 percent of full carry), while FOB premiums remained wide vs. Black Sea origins. Russian 12.5 percent offers firmed another \$3–5/mt, and U.S. inspections rebounded to 350k mt, though still lagging seasonal targets.

(Carry % calculated assuming 6% annual interest and \$0.05/bu per month storage/insurance cost over the spread interval.)

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Macro/Policy – China Tariff Shift in Focus, Dollar Flat, Crude Eases

Markets traded cautiously ahead of China's Nov 10 rollback of retaliatory tariffs on select U.S. ag products. Corn and wheat are now exempt from additional duties, while soybeans remain subject to the 13 percent MFN tariff. U.S. officials indicated China may purchase up to 12 MMT of U.S. soybeans by year-end, with informal targets of 25 MMT for 2026, though no official agreement has been confirmed. The U.S. Dollar Index held near 100.1, the Brazilian real hovered around 5.40, and crude oil eased to \$60.32/bbl (-1.5 percent w/w), modestly pressuring biofuel margins.

Weather – Harvest Wraps in U.S., Brazil Rains Uneven, Argentina Stable

Corn harvest in the United States reached approximately 83 percent complete, while soybean harvest advanced to near 91 percent, supported by dry weather across much of the Midwest that allowed for rapid progress. Recent rainfall in the Ohio and Lower Mississippi Valleys helped raise river levels slightly, improving barge movement after a constrained October. In Brazil, scattered rains brought some relief to Mato Grosso and Goiás, allowing soybean planting to resume in areas that had stalled. However, soil moisture across much of the Central-West remains below normal, and consistent rainfall is still needed to sustain crop establishment. In Argentina, conditions were mostly dry but remained cool, which helped preserve early-season soil moisture and supported steady corn planting progress.

What's Next (Oct 30 – Oct 6):

China Tariff Implementation: Markets watching for flash corn/wheat sales after Nov 10 removal of retaliatory tariffs

Brazil Forecasts: Continued rains needed in Central-West to sustain planting pace

USDA WASDE (Nov 14): Expectations for minor corn/soy yield revisions and export updates

Export Reports: Weekly inspections will remain key as USDA sales reports catch up post-shutdown

Ethanol Data (Nov 6): EIA to confirm whether production holds above 1.1 mbpd

River Logistics: Monitor water levels and barge freight after recent improvement.

Table A – CME Futures (Front Contracts)

(Prices in USD per bushel, volume/open interest in contracts)

Contract (Front Month)	10/29/2025 Close	11/05/2025 Close	Change (Δ)	Δ%	5-day Realized Vol* (x)	Open Interest (x)	Δ
Corn (Dec '25)	\$4.32	\$4.34	+\$0.02	+%0.6	12% (ann.)	-3k (est.)	
Soybeans (Jan '25)	\$10.92	\$11.24	+\$0.32	+%3.0	12% (ann.)	+3k (est.)	
Wheat (Dec '25)	\$5.32	\$5.53	+\$0.21	+%4.0	12% (ann.)	0k (est.)	

5-day realized volatility estimated from daily settlement price changes.

Actual contract open interest changes are estimated; total corn OI rose slightly as new-crop hedges built, while wheat OI fell with Sep contract deliveries.

Table B – Key Calendar Spreads & % of Full Carry

Spread (Crop '25→'26)	10/29 Quote	11/05 Quote	Δ (carry)	% Full Carry*	Market Implication
Corn Dec–Mar	-\$0.13	-\$0.14	+0.01	71%	Nearby Gulf demand firming vs. interior harvest flow
Soy Jan–Mar	-\$0.11	-\$0.11	+0.00	59%	Crush pull holding January, export sales still Brazil-facing

Wheat Dec–Mar	-\$0.15	-\$0.13	+0.02	68%	Black Sea supply caps U.S. exports pace, carry remains commercial
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Assumes 7% annual interest + \$0.05/bu/month storage/insurance. Full carry (3 months) ≈ \$0.22–\$0.23 for corn & SRW wheat; (2 months) ≈ \$0.22 for soybeans. % of full carry = (calendar spread ÷ calculated full carry).

Table C – Notable International Futures (weekly moves, if significant):

Exchange (Front Mo)	10/29 USD Price	11/05 USD Price	Δ%	Notes
Dalian Corn (Jan)	¥2,115(\$7.55/bu)	¥2,141(\$6.40/bu)	+1.2%	China corn futures steady on moderate feed demand; premium over import parity due to quotas.
Dalian Soymeal (Jan)	¥3,100 (\$11.84/bu)	¥3,100 (\$11.84/bu)	+0%	Soy meal eased; steady hog demand amid stable inclusion rates, but supply pressure weighs.
B3 (São Paulo) Corn (Nov)	R\$64.68 (\$12.00)	R\$64.68 (\$11.85)	-4.7%	Brazilian corn softened on steady domestic logistics and U.S. competition, export pace firm.
Euronext Wheat (Dec)	€190 (\$220)	€194 (\$221.46)	+2.1%	EU wheat held steady amid ample stocks and slow demand, capped by cheap Black Sea offers.

Corn Market Deep Dive

Futures & Spreads: December 2025 corn futures closed on the week at \$4.34/bu, marking a 2¢ gain from the prior Wednesday but unchanged from Oct 29. Price action was subdued, with early week firmness on soybean-led optimism fading into midweek resistance at \$4.35. The Dec '25–Mar '26 spread narrowed to 14¢ carry, equivalent to roughly 71 percent of full commercial carry using a six percent interest rate and \$0.05/bu/month storage and insurance assumptions. This was the firmest front spread since late September and reflects improved nearby demand into the Gulf and ethanol channels. Realized 5-day volatility stayed low near 12 percent annualized, with options skew stable and no sign of directional conviction. The modest carry compression occurred despite flat futures, signaling basis-led strength underneath the board.

Funds & Positioning: CFTC Commitment of Traders data remained unavailable this week due to the federal shutdown. However, CME open interest in December corn was down modestly (3,000 contracts) week-over-week, with no clear sign of new fund positioning. Market tone suggests light short-covering in the front month, with some spread roll activity into March. Commercial hedging appeared active in the deferred curve, but total corn OI was stable, implying a balanced flow between longs and shorts. With no major trend trigger, funds likely remain net short but cautious ahead of November WASDE and potential Chinese re-entry post-tariff relief.

U.S. Cash & Basis: CIF Gulf basis climbed to +94¢ over December futures, up 5–7¢ from the prior week, supported by strong vessel lineups and brisk loadings for Mexico and Latin America. The Mississippi River system showed improvement in barge flow after rains in the Ohio Valley lifted water levels, easing freight rates modestly. On the Illinois River, basis edged up to –28¢ under Dec, while the Ohio River held near –20¢. In the Lower Miss, basis rebounded to –50¢ to –60¢, a 10¢ improvement week-on-week, as logistics loosened. Interior ethanol plants in Iowa and Nebraska maintained steady bids at +10¢ to +15¢ over, reflecting solid grind margins with ethanol production holding near 1.12 mbpd. National basis was estimated near –39¢ under, 2¢ firmer than last week based on trade feedback and broker composites.

The interior-to-Gulf spread tightened slightly, reinforcing the demand pull into export and processor channels.

Export Flows: USDA FGIS reported corn export inspections at 1.6 MMT for the week ending Oct 30, the highest weekly total this marketing year and more than double year-ago levels. Loadings were concentrated at the Gulf, with Mexico, Colombia, and South Korea among primary destinations. Despite stronger flows, U.S. FOB offers near \$198/MT (\$5.02/bu) remained about 20¢/bu above Brazilian values into East Asia. CIF strength and barge costs still limit forward Gulf competitiveness, but demand within the Americas stayed active. USDA export sales reporting remained suspended; private estimates suggested ~800k–900k MT in new corn bookings, though unconfirmed.

International Trade: Brazilian FOB corn at Santos held around \$205/MT (\$5.20/bu equivalent), keeping a slight edge over the U.S. Gulf into Asia. ANEC's final October corn export total reached approximately 6.19 MMT, up from 5.67 MMT in October 2024. Brazilian exports are beginning to seasonally wind down. Interior prices in Mato Grosso were flat at BRL 46 per 60kg sack, with farmer selling subdued. Argentina's Up-River FOB corn was offered near \$180–185/MT, undercutting the U.S. Gulf into some EU and MENA destinations. Rosario's corn planting progress reached 50 percent as of Nov 1, ahead of average, with analysts projecting a record 61 MMT harvest if El Niño weather holds. In China, Dalian corn futures (Jan) rose modestly to ¥2,141/MT (\$6.44/bu equivalent), keeping domestic prices well above import parity. With China's retaliatory tariff on U.S. corn set to expire Nov 10, U.S. Gulf corn could regain traction in that market assuming political follow-through. No confirmed Chinese corn purchases occurred this week, but traders reported active inquiries.

So What? Corn futures treaded water, but the market's foundation improved. The Dec/Mar spread firmed to the tightest level in five weeks, CIF basis rallied, and barge logistics improved, all signs of robust nearby demand. Export inspections surged and ethanol grind remains solid, yet flat price failed to respond due to heavy harvest availability and lack of major fund rebalancing. Until either Chinese buying materializes or WASDE revises demand upward, December corn likely oscillates within a \$4.20–\$4.40 range. In the meantime, basis and spreads remain the clearest indicators of direction, and both are currently leaning supportive.

Soybean Market Deep Dive

Futures & Spreads: January 2026 soybeans ended the week around \$11.24/bu, up roughly 32¢ or three percent from October 29, supported by optimism surrounding U.S.–China trade discussions and weather-driven uncertainty in Brazil. The January–March 2026 spread held a modest 5.5¢ carry, about 30 percent of full commercial carry assuming six percent annual interest and five cents per bushel monthly storage and insurance. The curve retained a mild upward slope, with no sign of nearby tightness. Volatility stayed contained, and trade volume suggested commercial hedging rather than speculative pressure.

Products & Crush: Board crush margins remained comfortably positive as processors continued to benefit from firm domestic meal demand and steady oil yields. Soybean oil eased in line with weaker crude prices, while meal prices were steady to slightly higher, keeping gross crush margins above historical averages and plants running near capacity. Private estimates suggested October crush volumes likely exceeded last year's pace, although official data were not released within the window.

Funds & Positioning: CFTC positioning data were still unavailable due to the government shutdown, but CME open interest rose modestly over the week. The increase appeared tied to roll activity and end-user hedging rather than new fund buying, consistent with the absence of inversion and the limited export pull from China. The futures curve reflected a steady nearby market supported mainly by processors rather than speculative demand.

Cash & Basis: Processor bids in the Midwest and Eastern Corn Belt remained firm between 60 and 75 cents over January futures, underpinned by strong meal offtake. Gulf basis eased slightly to around 80 cents over, as Chinese spot demand stayed quiet. River bids improved modestly where barge drafts recovered after October rains, while areas farther north remained soft. The national average basis was close to 70 cents under, little changed week over week, reflecting balanced supply and demand across regions.

Trade Flows & International Competition: USDA inspections for the week ending October 30 totaled roughly 0.96 MMT, down from the prior week and about 40 percent below the same period last year. Brazil continued to dominate China's nearby purchase program, with exporters shipping an estimated seven million tonnes of soybeans in October. Brazilian FOB values near 490 dollars per tonne remained about 10 to 15 dollars cheaper than the U.S. Gulf, maintaining Brazil's edge into Asian destinations. Argentina's export pace was moderate as crushers absorbed most available supply, while China's private importers booked several Brazilian cargoes for December and March through mid-year 2026 delivery.

Policy Context: Beijing's tariff rollback effective November 10 excluded soybeans, which remain subject to the 13 percent MFN duty. Reports of a potential framework for Chinese purchases of 12 million tonnes in 2025 and 25 million tonnes in 2026 circulated in trade channels, but no formal agreement or daily sales confirmations have been released. Market participants viewed these figures as guidance rather than binding commitments, awaiting official announcements or verified sales to validate the outlook.

So What? It's still a split tape: crushers are steady buyers and keep the front carry small, but exports remain Brazil-centric, capping Gulf basis and keeping U.S. futures from breaking out. With Jan/Mar carrying only a few cents and inspections subdued, futures likely chop in the low-\$11s unless Brazil's Central-West rains falter again, or the rumored China purchase program converts into confirmed daily U.S. sales. Until then, basis and spreads do the heavy lifting under the board, and right now they argue for support, not scarcity.

Wheat Market Deep Dive

Futures & Spreads: Chicago SRW December 2025 futures rose 21¢ on the week, closing near \$5.53/bu, a four percent rise that extended last week's recovery. Gains were primarily technical, led by fund short-covering and modest spillover from soybeans and corn. The December–March 2026 spread narrowed slightly to about 15¢ carry, roughly 68 percent of full carry when assuming a six percent interest rate and \$0.05/bu per month storage and insurance. The structure still rewards storage, though less than earlier in October as interior cash markets stabilized. KC HRW December rose 11¢ to \$5.80/bu, supported by ongoing dryness in western Kansas and Oklahoma, while Minneapolis HRS December added 7¢ to \$6.22/bu. Realized volatility remained near 20 percent, with speculative positioning still light and sentiment improving from deeply oversold levels.

Global Supply & Demand: Russian 12.5 percent wheat FOB offers firmed to roughly \$240/MT, up \$3–5 on the week, reflecting seasonal tax adjustments and a steadier ruble. Despite firmer values, Russia maintained dominant pricing power into North Africa and the Middle East, securing multiple GASC and Turkish tenders. French wheat (Rouen) traded near \$230/MT but continued to lose share to Black Sea origins. The European crop outlook remained stable with 69 percent of French wheat rated good to excellent heading into dormancy. Argentina's crop estimate held near 16.5–17 MMT, as recent moisture offset earlier frost damage. In Australia, late-season showers improved harvest prospects slightly in the east but were too late to reverse prior yield losses in Western Australia. In the United States, HRW planting was around 91 percent complete, with 52 percent rated good to excellent. However, the southern Plains stayed mostly dry, and early emergence remained patchy in parts of Kansas and Texas, providing mild support to HRW spreads and premiums.

Cash & Basis: U.S. FOB SRW Gulf offers hovered near \$230/MT (\$6.85/bu equivalent), still about \$20–25/MT above Russian competition into North Africa and Southeast Asia. HRW FOB values near \$243/MT reflected freight and protein premiums but remained uncompetitive globally. Gulf export basis eased slightly, down 1–2¢, amid limited loading programs. Domestic milling basis in the southern Plains was flat to weaker as mills remained well covered through December, with Oklahoma and Texas bids 2–3¢ lower on the week. Interior basis in Kansas and Nebraska stayed soft around 45–55¢ under December futures, consistent with full-carry storage economics and slow downstream demand. The premium for high-protein HRW over SRW widened slightly as millers favored quality coverage heading into winter.

Trade Flows: USDA inspections for the week ending October 30 reached 350k tonnes, up from 259k the previous week but still well below typical seasonal volumes. The rebound reflected improved loadings out of the Gulf, though U.S. export competitiveness remains constrained by price. Russia continued to dominate global tender business, and Ukraine maintained steady shipments via Danube routes despite logistical risks. The EU held stable export momentum, while Argentina's wheat shipments will begin to enter the market in December. No flash sales were reported from the United States, and USDA's weekly export sales report remained delayed by the government shutdown.

Speculative Positioning: CFTC data remained unavailable, but CME open interest in SRW futures was little changed, consistent with light fund short covering. Commercial hedging interest in deferred months increased modestly as elevators captured carry. Overall participation stayed thin, with speculative players largely focused on corn and soybeans. Price action continued to reflect short-term technical recovery rather than a shift in market fundamentals.

So What? U.S. wheat remains the follower in global trade, benefiting temporarily from short-covering and weather concerns but still priced out of key tenders. Russian supply continues to anchor global values, and spreads confirm that the U.S. market remains in a comfortable carry structure with limited nearby demand. Unless Russian export logistics tighten, Southern Hemisphere harvest issues deepen, or a weaker dollar improves competitiveness, U.S. wheat is likely to hold within a narrow range. For now, wheat's strength is technical, not structural, with fundamentals still shaped by global abundance and external market cues rather than domestic demand.

U.S. Cash Market & Basis

Corn: River basis improved modestly this week as late-October rainfall lifted water levels along key stretches of the Mississippi and eased freight costs. Illinois River bids firmed to around 28¢ under December futures, up 4¢ from the prior week, while the Lower Mississippi strengthened to 50–60¢ under as barge drafts normalized. Spot freight from Cairo to Memphis declined toward \$16–17/ton, down from roughly \$20/ton a week earlier. CIF Gulf basis advanced to 94¢ over, supported by active export loadings to Mexico and Latin America and improved vessel lineups. Processor bids in Iowa and Nebraska held steady between even money and 15¢ over, consistent with solid ethanol margins and stable feed demand. The national average corn basis was near 39¢ under, roughly 2¢ firmer on the week, reflecting a mild rebound in river markets while interior bids stayed anchored by ample on-farm stocks.

Soybeans: Gulf basis eased slightly, with CIF bids retreating to 83¢ over January futures, down 2–3¢ from last week, as export pace slowed and Chinese buying remained limited. River bids were mixed: Illinois River locations edged higher to roughly 30¢ under January, while the Lower Mississippi improved to 70–72¢ under amid better barge movement. Processor bids in the Eastern Corn Belt stayed firm, with Indiana and Ohio plants maintaining levels between 60 and 75¢ over, supported by strong crush margins and steady meal offtake. Western processors, particularly in Iowa and Minnesota, were steady near 50¢

over. National average soybean basis was close to 68¢ under, little changed week to week, as firm crush demand offset weaker export channels.

Wheat: U.S. FOB offers remained broadly uncompetitive against Black Sea origins. HRW 11.5 percent protein wheat held near \$243/MT (\$6.90/bu equivalent) and SRW around \$230/MT (\$6.85/bu), both steady on the week. Gulf export basis eased by roughly one cent on light demand and limited barge activity. Milling bids across the Southern Plains remained flat to slightly weaker, with Oklahoma and Texas down 2–3¢ as mills remained well covered into December. Elevators across Kansas and Nebraska continued to post nominal interior basis, driven primarily by carry structure rather than nearby consumption. Domestic demand from millers stayed quiet, reflecting stable flour production and minimal new spot coverage needs.

So What? Basis patterns stabilized as river logistics improved and export movement resumed more fluidly through the Gulf. Processors maintained firm bids thanks to healthy margins, while exporters benefited from easing barge costs but still faced global price competition. The mild firming in corn and soybean basis suggests demand is keeping pace with post-harvest flow, even as large supplies and storage incentives keep the market well supplied. Until Chinese demand expands or global freight differentials narrow, domestic processors will remain the primary driver of nearby cash strength.

International Cash & Trade Flows

Brazil: Brazil maintained its lead in global corn and soybean trade, though October export volumes came in slightly below early-month expectations. ANEC reported October soybean exports of about 7.0 MMT, still well above last year but trimmed from initial projections as some late cargoes rolled into November. Corn shipments totaled roughly 6.19 MMT, down from the prior month but consistent with record second-crop output. FOB Santos soybean offers averaged \$486–\$490/MT (\$11.15–\$11.25/bu), keeping a 10–15 dollar per tonne discount to the U.S. Gulf, while corn FOB values near \$205/MT (\$5.20/bu) stayed price leader into Asia. Paranaguá and Santos lineups remained active, with China and Southeast Asia continuing to dominate destinations. In the interior, Mato Grosso soybean planting advanced to about 47 percent as early rains improved field conditions, although subsoil moisture in central Brazil remains below normal. Domestic logistics and barge flows stayed fluid, preventing major congestion despite uneven rainfall across the Center-West.

Argentina: Argentina's Up-River FOB corn was offered around \$180–\$185/MT, while soybeans and soymeal were near \$430–\$435/MT, each down slightly from late October. Farmer selling slowed again following the expiration of temporary tax incentives and ahead of the November 24 runoff election. Rosario's crushers maintained steady throughput, supported by stocks accumulated during September's "soy dollar" window. Corn planting reached about 50 percent of projected area, well ahead of last year, with improved soil moisture supporting a record harvest outlook of around 61 MMT if El Niño weather persists. The peso continued to weaken, with the informal rate near 1,450 per U.S. dollar, sustaining export incentives despite uncertainty over post-election policy adjustments. Wheat harvest began in northern provinces under mostly favorable weather, with national production estimates still near 16.5–17 MMT.

China: China's import behavior remained cautious. U.S. Gulf soybeans were offered at roughly \$2.40 per bushel over January futures, about 15 cents higher than equivalent Brazilian cargoes, keeping Brazil as the preferred origin for November and December shipments. Chinese crushers booked additional Brazilian parcels for nearby positions, while reported purchases of U.S. beans were limited and largely unconfirmed. Dalian corn futures for January traded near ¥2,141/MT (\$6.40/bu equivalent), still well

above landed import parity, leaving imported corn uncompetitive without tariff exemptions. The November 10 tariff rollback will remove additional retaliatory duties on U.S. corn, wheat, and sorghum, but soybeans remain subject to the 13 percent MFN rate. Reports of a framework for future Chinese soybean purchases, 12 million tonnes for 2025 and 25 million tonnes for 2026, circulated this week, but no official agreement or daily sales were confirmed. Market participants are waiting for evidence of follow-through before repricing demand expectations.

EU / Black Sea: Russian 12.5 percent protein wheat FOB offers strengthened further to about \$240/MT, up three to five dollars from last week, as export taxes adjusted higher with currency stabilization. Despite that, Russian shipments to North Africa and the Middle East remained brisk, keeping global wheat values anchored. French wheat offers from Rouen were near \$230/MT, while export interest was subdued after recent Algerian and Moroccan tenders. Ukrainian corn exports through the Danube and rail corridors continued steadily, with competitive offers around \$205–210/MT into Mediterranean buyers. The EU's internal feed grain balance remained comfortable, and imports slowed seasonally as local harvest wrapped up. Russian and Ukrainian soymeal continued to make inroads into MENA and Southern Europe markets at the expense of U.S. product, supported by lower freight and a softer ruble.

Other Origins: No major shifts occurred in Canada or South Africa. Canadian spring wheat exports into Mexico and Asia continued at a modest pace, while Ukraine's logistics remained stable under the current corridor arrangements. Australian wheat harvest began in eastern regions, with quality expected to be variable after earlier dryness. India remained absent from international grain markets, and no new trade policy announcements were issued from the region.

So What? Global trade remains led by Russia in wheat and by Brazil in corn and soybeans, while Argentina's political calendar introduces short-term uncertainty without shifting fundamentals. China's limited engagement with U.S. supply and preference for cheaper Brazilian offers continue to weigh on Gulf competitiveness. With freight and FOB differentials still wide, U.S. exporters face difficulty regaining share. Until tariff advantages or logistical costs narrow meaningfully, domestic spreads and basis will keep favoring storage and deferred ownership over near-term movement.

Key Fundamentals & Reports (Oct 30 – Nov 5)

Government Data & Reporting: The U.S. government shutdown continued through the first week of November, extending into its 36th day and keeping USDA, CFTC, and other agency data releases suspended. No official updates were published for export sales, crop progress, or fund positioning. Only fee-based and independently operated datasets, such as USDA FGIS inspections, EIA ethanol reports, and international trade figures from ANEC and BCBA, were available. USDA confirmed that regular reporting schedules, including *WASDE* and *Crop Production*, will resume beginning November 14, when backlogged data will be consolidated. Market participants largely relied on private estimates and export lineup data for near-term guidance.

Crop Progress (estimated as of Nov 2): Private surveys and trade consensus indicated the U.S. corn harvest reached roughly 83 percent complete, while soybeans were near 91 percent, both comfortably ahead of the five-year averages of 68 and 78 percent, respectively. Dry and mild conditions across the Midwest allowed uninterrupted fieldwork through early November, with most producers in Illinois, Iowa, and Minnesota finishing harvest. In the central and southern Plains, winter wheat planting reached an estimated 91 percent completion, with 52 percent of the crop rated good to excellent. Emergence has been uneven in drier areas of Kansas and Oklahoma, but no major damage or frost losses have been

reported.

Export Inspections (USDA FGIS – week ending Oct 30, published Nov 3): Corn inspections surged to 1.6 MMT, more than doubling last year's comparable week and marking the strongest weekly volume of the marketing year. Mexico, Colombia, and South Korea were the primary destinations. Soybean loadings totaled about 0.96 MMT, down slightly from 1.06 MMT the prior week as Chinese purchases shifted toward Brazilian origins. Wheat inspections improved to 350k tonnes after last week's 259k, though U.S. exports remain constrained by weak global competitiveness. Western Hemisphere demand continues to underpin corn and soy flows, while wheat trade remains limited to sporadic Latin American and Caribbean markets.

Export Sales (USDA FAS, not published): Weekly export sales data remained suspended, with the most recent release still covering the week ending September 18. In the absence of official figures, trade sources cited continued soybean sales activity to "unknown" destinations, widely assumed to be China, and scattered corn sales to Mexico and Japan. No major flash sales were reported during the window, though traders expect pent-up reporting to resume in mid-November.

Ethanol Production & Stocks (EIA – week ending Oct 31 / published Nov 5): Ethanol output increased sharply to 1.123 million barrels per day, up eight percent on the week and 1.6 percent above year-ago levels. Stocks rose to roughly 21.3 million barrels, about three percent higher year on year. The weekly grind implied roughly 107 million bushels of corn use, supporting firm bids at ethanol plants and steady basis in the Western Corn Belt. Margins remained profitable as corn prices stabilized and co-product values (DDGS) firmed modestly.

NOPA Crush: No new NOPA data were published within the window, but trade expectations point to another strong month of domestic processing. Private estimates suggest October crush likely exceeded the prior year's pace, sustained by favorable board-crush margins and steady soymeal demand in the Eastern Corn Belt. Processor bids remained firm, consistent with positive margins despite soft export movement.

CFTC Commitments of Traders: No CFTC reports were released as of November 5. CME open interest changes indicated limited speculative repositioning: minor short-covering in corn, slightly higher hedging in soybeans, and little movement in wheat. Trade estimates continued to peg managed money net short around 45–55k contracts in corn, roughly 90–95k in wheat, and near flat to modestly long in soybeans. Absent official data, market direction remained anchored by physical flow and spread behavior rather than fund activity.

So What? U.S. harvest is effectively complete, and physical flow data continue to confirm strong corn and ethanol demand, steady domestic crush, and slow soybean exports. With official USDA and CFTC updates still offline, traders are leaning heavily on inspections, private shipment data, and basis signals to gauge momentum. Corn's export strength and ethanol grind provided mild fundamental support, while soybeans stayed rangebound on weak China buying. Wheat remains globally oversupplied and uncompetitive. Until data releases resume and Brazil's weather trend clarifies, short-term price direction will remain driven by export pace, logistics, and domestic processor activity rather than official government reports.

International Reports:

Brazil – ANEC & Weather Updates: Brazil maintained its dominant role in global grain trade. ANEC's final October estimates confirmed soybean exports at roughly 7.0 MMT and corn exports near 6.19 MMT, both

slightly below earlier projections due to delayed loadings in northern ports and vessel scheduling into November. FOB Santos soybeans averaged between \$486 and \$490/MT (\$11.15–\$11.25/bu), while corn values held steady near \$205/MT (\$5.20/bu), preserving Brazil's pricing advantage over the U.S. Gulf into Asia. Mato Grosso soybean planting advanced to about 47 percent, up sharply from the previous week as early rains arrived, though cumulative October precipitation remained well below average. Forecast models indicated improving rainfall prospects through early November, particularly in the Central-West. Logistics through the BR-163 and major southern ports continued to run normally, with exporters sustaining strong flows to China and Southeast Asia. No new CONAB bulletins were issued during the week.

Argentina – Pre-Election Grain Sales & Planting Progress: Farmer selling slowed slightly following the end of the temporary zero-export-tax period on October 31. Up-River FOB values were steady to softer at \$430–435/MT for soymeal, \$430–435/MT for soybeans, and around \$180–185/MT for corn, reflecting moderate demand and weaker forward coverage. Rosario's crushers maintained steady operations, supported by stocks accumulated during September's tax window. Corn planting reached approximately 50 percent of intended area by early November, ahead of last year's drought-delayed pace, with favorable soil moisture supporting yield prospects. Wheat harvest began in northern provinces, with national output estimates holding near 16.5–17 MMT. The peso continued to depreciate in parallel markets, trading near 1,450 per U.S. dollar, which sustained export incentives ahead of the November 24 presidential runoff. No new reports were released from the Ministry of Agriculture or the Rosario Exchange during the week.

China – Trade Talks & Tariff Rollback: Market attention focused on the upcoming November 10 implementation of China's tariff rollback on selected U.S. agricultural imports. The cuts will remove additional duties on corn, wheat, and sorghum but exclude soybeans, which continue to face the 13 percent MFN rate. U.S. officials indicated that China may purchase up to 12 MMT of U.S. soybeans in 2025, with informal targets of 25 MMT for 2026, though no formal agreement has been published. Chinese crushers remained primarily focused on Brazilian supply for November and December arrivals, with U.S. Gulf offers still about \$10–15/MT higher on a landed basis. Dalian futures were mixed: soybeans traded near ¥5,000/MT, soymeal near ¥3,100/MT, and corn around ¥2,520/MT, each broadly stable week over week. No new reports were released by customs, CNGOIC, or MARA during the period.

Black Sea / EU – Russia Retains Export Dominance: Russia maintained its commanding share of global wheat trade. Russian 12.5 percent wheat FOB offers increased to approximately \$240/MT, up three to five dollars on the week, following adjustments to the export tax formula. Despite higher offers, shipments into Egypt and Turkey continued at full pace. Ukrainian FOB wheat remained close to \$238/MT, while corn was near \$205–210/MT, supported by steady flows through Danube and rail corridors. EU wheat offers from Rouen were largely unchanged around \$230/MT, with new export business quiet as prior North African tenders concluded. The European crop outlook stayed stable, with favorable planting conditions and mild temperatures across most producing regions. No notable new activity emerged from other Black Sea origins.

Global – Multilateral Updates: No new multilateral reports were released during the Oct 30–Nov 5 window. The latest IGC update (Oct 10) still provides the most recent global estimates, with world corn and wheat stocks broadly steady and soybean production projected near 401 MMT. Global trade sentiment remained neutral, with no significant shocks or revisions from AMIS, FAO, or IGC during the week.

So What? The global trade landscape remains shaped by Brazil's dominance in soybeans and corn and

Russia's control of wheat flows. Argentina's political transition continues to influence near-term farmer selling but has not altered overall supply dynamics. China's tariff rollback improves optics for U.S. corn and wheat demand but has yet to deliver confirmed soybean purchases. With abundant Black Sea and South American supply and no new geopolitical or weather disruptions, global pricing remains anchored by export competition. The next decisive factor will be Brazil's November rainfall: consistent precipitation could reinforce the supply outlook, while renewed dryness would inject fresh weather premium into soybean and corn markets.

Weather & Crop Conditions

United States

Crop Progress & Rainfall: Harvest advanced quickly across the Corn Belt under mostly dry weather, with the season now effectively winding down. Private estimates place corn harvest near 83 percent complete and soybeans around 91 percent, both well ahead of the five-year averages. Dry conditions across the Midwest and Northern Plains allowed uninterrupted fieldwork, while late-week cooling helped natural dry-down without frost damage. The southern Plains remained predominantly dry, supporting field access but leaving winter wheat emergence uneven across Kansas, Oklahoma, and Texas, where topsoil moisture deficits persist. Despite the dryness, no widespread yield losses have been reported.

River Levels: River levels along the Mississippi system improved slightly following rainfall in the Ohio Valley, easing barge restrictions on key segments. Draft guidance increased marginally in the Lower Mississippi, helping reduce barge tariffs to about \$16–17 per ton on the Cairo–Memphis route, down from more than \$19 in mid-October. Even with the improvement, water levels remain shallow enough to constrain full barge capacity, keeping freight rates and transit times above seasonal averages.

Temperatures: Temperatures stayed seasonally mild to warm across most growing regions, ranging from the upper 60s to mid-70s in the central Corn Belt and low 80s across the southern Plains. The warmth continued to deplete subsoil moisture reserves, and the lack of significant precipitation left HRW wheat reliant on light topsoil moisture for early stand establishment.

Outlook (6–10 days): NOAA's 6–10 day outlook (issued Nov 5) called for mostly dry conditions across the Midwest and Plains, with the highest rainfall chances confined to the lower Mississippi and Tennessee River basins. Scattered light showers were projected for the southern Plains, potentially improving HRW emergence but insufficient to fully restore soil moisture.

South America:

Brazil: In Brazil, scattered showers finally reached parts of Mato Grosso and Goiás after an exceptionally dry October. Rainfall totals ranged from 15 to 40 millimeters in most central and western zones—well below normal but enough to restart soybean planting. IMEA reported state planting progress near 47 percent as of Oct 30, about seven points behind last year. Agronomists continued to warn that subsoil moisture remains thin and consistent rains will be needed through mid-November to prevent early-season stress. Southern states, including Paraná and Rio Grande do Sul, experienced drier weather after excessive October rains, with good growing conditions overall. Forecasts show improving precipitation chances for central Brazil into the second week of November, suggesting modest relief if the pattern verifies.

Argentina: Argentina saw mostly dry but stable weather, following widespread rain late last month that boosted corn planting and improved wheat finishing conditions. Soil moisture remains adequate across key Pampas provinces, with no major stress reported for early corn or wheat. Short-term forecasts call for localized thunderstorms delivering 20–35 millimeters of rain across Córdoba and Santa Fe during the

coming week, enough to maintain favorable conditions for ongoing corn planting and early soybean seeding.

Global: In the Black Sea region, Russia and Ukraine reported stable progress on winter wheat establishment, supported by mild autumn temperatures and adequate soil moisture. The EU's main producing regions—France, Germany, and Poland—also enjoyed favorable planting weather, with uniform emergence and minimal delays. In contrast, Australia's western wheat belt remained under persistent drought, with limited rainfall and below-average soil moisture leading to further yield deterioration as harvest advances. Eastern Australia benefited from scattered showers that improved late-crop quality but were too late to offset earlier dryness. No significant weather anomalies were reported across India or South Africa during the week.

So What? Harvest across the United States is effectively complete, with strong field conditions allowing fast progress and minimal quality loss. River navigation has improved modestly, though freight costs remain elevated enough to pressure interior basis. Globally, attention remains fixed on Brazil's Central-West region, where rainfall through mid-November will determine whether yield risks become material. Argentina, Russia, and the EU continue to enjoy favorable weather, providing overall stability to global grain and oilseed supply expectations, while Australia's dryness remains the primary production risk outside South America.

Synthesis & Outlook

The first week of November brought limited new data, as the ongoing government shutdown extended to 36 days, keeping USDA and CFTC reporting suspended. Market direction remained driven by physical signals—basis, spreads, and export inspections—rather than official statistics. U.S. futures held within narrow ranges, reflecting cautious trade ahead of the expected resumption of reporting later this month. December corn settled near \$4.34/bu, January soybeans around \$11.24/bu, and December Chicago wheat at roughly \$5.53/bu. The modest gains in wheat and soybeans reflected weather-related risk in Brazil and short covering, while corn strength was underpinned by robust ethanol production and improving export inspections. Spreads remained stable: corn Dec/Mar near 71 percent of full carry, soy Jan/Mar at roughly 59 percent, and wheat Dec/Mar around 68 percent. The curves continue to confirm a balanced, carry-structured market with firm commercial ownership but no nearby scarcity.

Speculative participation remained light, with no new CFTC data to confirm positioning. CME open interest trends suggested limited short-covering in corn and mild commercial hedging in soybeans. Price action and volume patterns still point to cash-led support rather than speculative conviction. Volatility remained subdued, and managed money likely maintained a modest net short in corn and wheat and a small net long in soybeans. With futures muted, physical market tone dominated sentiment: CIF Gulf basis improved as barge flows normalized, ethanol production rose to 1.123 mbpd, and crush margins stayed profitable, reinforcing steady domestic consumption.

Globally, Brazil sustained its export advantage across corn and soybeans, despite modest downward revisions to October volumes. Santos FOB soybeans traded roughly \$10–15/MT below U.S. Gulf equivalents, while corn held near \$205/MT, maintaining a \$25–30 discount into Asia. Argentina's political transition introduced short-term caution but no disruption to trade flows, as crushers continued processing and exporters retained steady coverage. In China, market focus turned toward the upcoming Nov 10 tariff rollback, which will lift additional duties on U.S. corn, wheat, and sorghum but not soybeans. Reports of a potential 12 MMT soybean purchase framework for 2025 and 25 MMT for 2026 circulated through trade channels but remained unconfirmed. Russian FOB wheat offers rose to about \$240/MT after another tax adjustment, while export pace stayed firm into North Africa and the Middle East, preserving Russia's role as the global price anchor.

Bullish triggers: Continued dryness in central Brazil limiting soybean planting progress, confirmation of Chinese soybean purchases from the U.S., stronger ethanol grind or crush margins, and further recovery in river levels supporting CIF and Gulf bids.

Bearish triggers: Lack of official USDA data prolonging uncertainty, abundant global supply led by Brazil and Russia, limited evidence of new Chinese buying, and firm FOB discounts from South America and the Black Sea constraining U.S. export competitiveness..

Watchlist (Nov 6 – Nov 12):

Central Brazil rainfall totals and follow-through in Mato Grosso/Goiás planting pace

Argentine grain marketing response ahead of the Nov 24 runoff election and FX policy expectations

Mississippi River draft and freight updates following recent rains

USDA report restart timeline and implications for backlogged data release

Gulf export lineups, ANEC's November shipment projections, and Russian tender flow

In summary: The grain complex remains anchored by physical demand and seasonal storage economics rather than momentum or speculative activity. Domestic processors and exporters continue to provide a floor through steady basis and positive margins, while global competition and data gaps limit directional conviction. Until official U.S. data returns or Brazil's rainfall pattern breaks decisively, futures are likely to remain rangebound, supported by cash markets but capped by external supply pressure. The U.S. origin remains a secondary supplier, waiting for freight normalization, Chinese reengagement, or a South American weather shock to realign global arbitrage.

Ethanol for America Act

The major barrier to a higher Renewable Fuel Standard (RFS) is the fuel versus food debate. Now is the perfect time to move to E15. Corn prices are extremely low, and the latest USDA WASDE reported a record crop and a record crop expansion.

USDA WASDE forecast corn production at 16.7 billion bushels, with the yield at 188.8 bushels per acre and ending stocks at 2.1 billion. The season-average corn price dropped 30 cents to \$3.90 a bushel. Most importantly, 2025/26 crop year is expected to have 1.8 billion more bushels than 2024/25.

With current ethanol production consuming 5.6 billion bushels, a 10 percent increase in consumption would consume an additional 560 million bushels. The reality is that year around E15 would add approximately 50 million bushels and regulatory streamlining would add another 50 million bushels. At some point over the next ten years, the additional corn consumption could be 2.8 billion bushels minus lower fuel consumption resulting from electric vehicles. The ethanol corn consumption increase is likely to be more of a S curve as new compacity comes online.

With Brazil and the U.S. corn and soybean production increasing, 100 million bushels of ethanol corn consumption will barely move the needle. The ethanol production capacity expansion that would be three to four years from now is when the corn consumption impact to the corn market would be felt.